AHEAD WITH KK

Show the small price honestly: a guide to EMI and monthly pricing

for anyone selling something costly: courses, furniture, electronics, treatments, memberships

> **What I saw.** An iPad price card in a Bangalore mall: "₹85,900 or ₹3,746 p.m." in big letters. The small print: ₹85,900 is the ₹89,900 MRP after a ₹4,000 cashback on certain bank cards, and ₹3,746 is computed on a 33% down payment and 16 months.

Research says. A price cut into small pieces feels smaller. Marketing professor John Gourville called it "pennies-a-day" (Journal of Consumer Research, 1998).

☐ 1. Offer a monthly or per-day number

- "₹2,500 a month" or "₹83 a day" feels lighter than one big number. Use it if you can actually offer it.

☐ 2. Put the full price right next to it, the same size

- My take: hiding the total gets the first yes and loses the second. People who feel tricked don't refer friends.

☐ 3. State the conditions in one plain line

- "With 1/3 paid now, then 12 months." "Only with HDFC cards." No one should discover it at billing.

☐ 4. Compare to something everyday

- "Less than your daily coffee" works only if it's true. Do the math before you say it.

☐ 5. Make it easy to say yes

- A payment link, UPI, a clear EMI partner. The small price means nothing if the payment step is confusing.

Practical steps, not financial advice. Follow the rules for any loan or EMI product you offer.